

Vanuatu



Area 4,710 sq miles
(12,200 sq km)

Population 200,000

Capital Port-Vila

Currency Vatu

Official languages Bislama,
English, and French

Life expectancy 70 years



In the South Pacific, Vanuatu is an archipelago of 82 mountainous islands of volcanic origin. It was formerly known as the New Hebrides. Ruled jointly by France and Britain from 1906, Vanuatu became independent in 1980.

Fiji



Area 7,054 sq miles
(18,270 sq km)

Population 900,000

Capital Suva

Currency Fiji dollar

Official language English

Life expectancy 69 years



Fiji is a volcanic archipelago in the southern Pacific Ocean, made up of two main islands and nearly 900 smaller islands and islets. Melanesians and ethnic Indians make up its population. Recent coups have affected Fiji's political stability.



▲ LEVUKA

Fiji's former capital, Levuka, is a picturesque town on Ovalau Island, with buildings that are unchanged since colonial times.

New Zealand



Area 103,737 sq miles
(268,680 sq km)

Population 4.4 million

Capital Wellington

Currency New Zealand dollar

Official languages English
and Maori

Life expectancy 80 years



Lying in the South Pacific, New Zealand is made up of the main North and South islands, separated by the Cook Strait, and a number of smaller islands. South Island is the more mountainous, while North Island contains hot springs and geysers.

The bulk of the population lives on North Island. Nearly three-quarters of the population are descendants of European migrants, while about 15 percent are Maori (migrants from Polynesia). Thanks to its small population and limited industry, New Zealand is one of the least polluted nations on Earth. It was also the first to give women the right to vote, in 1893.

▼ GLACIER WALKING

The Franz Josef Glacier (below) and the Fox Glacier on South Island's west coast are two of New Zealand's main tourist attractions. Thousands visit the glaciers every year.

